

Web Resources

Language	Sites
HTML	www.htmlhelp.com, www.htmlgoodies.com, www.pageresource.com
PHP	www.php.net, www.phpbuilder.com, www.php-resources.org, www.scripts.com, www.phpfreaks.com
ASP & ASP.NET	www.asp.net, www.worldofasp.net
Java, JSP	java.sun.com/javascript/, www.javascriptworld.com, www.javascript.com
XML	www.xml.org, www.topxml.com, www.xmlinfo.com, www.xmlpitstop.com
Perl	www.perl.org, www.perlmonks.org, www.theperlreview.com, www.perlcast.com
Python	www.python.org
All languages	www.w3c.org, www.w3schools.com, www.webdeveloper.com, www.programmersheaven.com, www.opendev.org

ty, and is not standardised. One should assess the quality of education and placement credibility before enrolling in a private institution.

A decent demand for Web programmers lies in the Web portals industry, which by and large works in sync with educational institutions for the development of up-to-date computer labs for education in accordance with industry requirements, and for offering internships to students.

“The biggest challenge faced by programmers is obsolescence of their skill sets. The best bet is to invest time and effort in understanding the fundamental protocols and concepts well. Once this is done, any new programming framework or language can be very easily picked up, since vendors may change the syntax of programming, but they still need to fit it within the fundamental protocols, which never change,” says Sudipto Majumdar, CTO, Zapak.com, a leading Indian gaming portal.

Recruitment

Web portals recruit programmers on a large basis for research and development on their sites. A good programmer is expected to possess networking and hardware knowledge—knowledge of servers, routers, VPNs, and such. A blend of excellent software skills and decent hardware knowledge is a winning recipe for a fresher.

“On the software and programming skills front, logic is more important than any coding language. Programmers should select a language and upgrade themselves in that area instead of learning several languages and then become a jack of all trades. A good Web programmer should also understand the business logic behind Web site development,” says Sukhwil.

Training

Training on the work process and development parameters is imparted by the organisation itself. “Depending upon the individual, training on networking concepts, Web protocol concepts, programming language training, database designing and conceptualisation, and Web site architectural concepts are imparted,” informs Majumdar.

The training period is usually between one and six months. During this period, the fresh employee is placed under a senior programmer.

Levels And Remuneration

Promotions and appraisals depend more upon the performance and individual contribution in a project as compared to experience in the field. The figures mentioned here are only indicative.



Adding to the demand for Web programmers is the advent of mobile phones that support browsing. There is a need for trained and skilled people who can build sites for the mobile platform”

Lincoln Gada
CTO
Hungama.com

Level 1: At the entry level, most of the Web programming activity is done by Junior Programmers and Senior Programmers.

Junior Programmers / Software Engineers: They need to understand their assigned modules, and code and develop applications for particular modules of the broader Web site architecture.

Senior Programmers / Engineers: They are responsible for framing the site architecture and develop the different Web page applications and functions. The modular functionality of the site programmed by the junior programmers are tested, debugged, and then approved by them.

Level 2: A certain amount of management capacity is demanded of a senior programmer advancing to this level.

Team Leader: He assesses the needs of the team and designates work to the team members. His job also involves some programming along with testing and validation of the prototypes prepared by his team. The team leader helps junior and senior programmers to understand the architecture and functionality of the project.

Assistant Project Manager: This designation carries with it the tracking of the progress of the project, documenting progress reports, and passing on these to the project leader. They give project briefs to team leaders and maintain the project documentation.

Level 3: After reaching the top level, one can decide upon whether one wishes to be more on the technological or management side. This level is composed of the Project Managers and the Solution Architects.

Project Managers: Getting business, maintaining the design protocol standards of the organisation, interacting with clients for details about their requirements, and demonstration of prototypes to clients form the major part of their work profile.

Solution Architects: They focus on the architectural aspect of the site development projects. Solutions for adoption of particular products or software platforms for Web development are designed by these individuals.

A Closing Note

“The sky is the limit for good Web programmers, because slowly all programming is migrating from the traditional client / server model or Desktop-based programs to Web-based programming. With Web 2.0 picking up fast, AJAX programmers are in demand,” says Majumdar.

Web programming is an exciting career for those who can learn programming quickly and

also feel the itch to make a better Web site when they see a poorly-made one. Learning the languages comes first; implementing that learning can be financially rewarding—and fun as well! ■

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Experience Required—And Remuneration		
Designation	Salary per annum (Rs in lakhs)	Relevant Experience (years)
Junior Programmer	0.6 - 2.4	2 - 3
Senior Programmer	2.4 - 4.8	3 - 5
Team Leader	5 - 10	5 - 7
Asst. Project Manager	10 - 14	7 - 8
Project Lead/Manager	15 - 25	8 - 12
Solution Architect	15 and above	8 - 15